

Write a 300 word, or more, reflection on a specific disability. Do you feel people with that disability are respectfully represented in a film of your choice. Why or why not?

The film i want to discuss is one of my personal favourites “Me before you”

Me Before You (2016) explores the life of Will Traynor, a young man who becomes quadriplegic after a motorcycle accident. The film focuses on his relationship with Louisa Clark, his caregiver, and examines how disability can affect a person's identity, independence, and outlook on life. While the film is emotional and thought-provoking, its representation of quadriplegia has generated both praise and criticism.

My thoughts

I believe the film succeeds in showing some realities faced by people with severe physical disabilities. Will's dependence on caregivers, the physical challenges he experiences, and the frustration of losing abilities he once had are portrayed in a way that encourages viewers to consider the emotional impact of a life-changing injury. The film also highlights the importance of support systems, friendships, and meaningful relationships.

As someone who lives with a disability, this aspect of the film stood out to me. While I appreciated the emotional storytelling and the way the film encouraged conversations about disability not talked about enough, I felt it focused heavily on loss which I feel is an uncomfortable reality with severe disabilities yet I appreciated the rawness. I feel other films would rather focus on adaptation and possibility for a more happy ending. The film presents one individual's experience, but I find it relatable in the way of not wanting to accept living with a severe disability.

Overall, *Me Before You* raises important questions about disability, choice, and quality of life. I highly recommend it, While it offers some respectful insights into the challenges of quadriplegia, it chooses to focus on the more stubborn archetype and realities of the emotional impact rather than provide a balanced representation of what life with a disability can look like.